64th Republic Day celebrations on 26 January 2013.

The new Treaty of 2007 is most unlikely to bring in qualitative changes in Indo-Bhutan relation. Given the need, both ways, India and Bhutan most likely would follow the same amicable relations. The updated Treaty of 2007 like the 1949 Treaty, reiterates that there shall be perpetual peace and friendship between India and Bhutan.

India's Look-East Policy

It was only in 1992 that India's Look East Policy (LEP) was launched. This was a foreign policy posture of India to reach out to their South-eastern neighbours and also connect with East Asia. The chief objectives of LEP are to renew political contacts with the countries of South-east Asia and East Asia, increase economic cooperation and most importantly secure strategic defence cooperation to balance expanding Chinese influence in South-east Asia and South China Sea and areas beyond that.

Earlier, during the Cold War years, India's insistence on non-alignment had retracted India to limit her activities to South Asia. Again, with the defeat of India in the hands of China compelled India to restrain herself to expanding beyond South Asia. Further, India refrained from entering into a broad alliance being envisaged by the South-east Asian countries to counter China. This also distanced India from them. Later, also India's obsession with South Asia greatly hindered her vision of expanding beyond this region. With the end of Cold War, followed by economic liberalization of India, launching LEP became a need of the hour for India. Seeking economic cooperation of immediate neighbours was a viable option rather than negotiating economic ties with the bigger countries, especially the developed ones. With this objective an initiative to develop policy towards South-east Asia and East Asian countries started making rounds in the MEA in the early 1990s. Ultimately, the LEP was launched in 1992.

Immediately, it started reaping dividends for India. India's contact with ASEAN was rewarding. India was made the Sectoral Dialogue Partner in 1992, and become the Full Dialogue Partner in the Fifth ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF) on 23 July 1996. India became